media answerable to its observers, to make agencies watchable, and to break the hold on information maintained by governments and their collaborating Fourth Estates. There would have to be an alternative gathering process, a gathering process that would combine new information with the information you already know about the world. It would mean contextualising it for all these different actors. We would require a way that kept the actors honest, which is why WikiLeaks – which would grow out of this yoking of quantum mechanics to journalistic ethics – would require the involvement of the mainstream press in the effort to publish material that led to a greater state of justice. In this way, the flow of information would not be a matter for single journalists alone, or for individual media organisations, but for societies working together.

At the time I was still at university, but everything had led to this, and there was some way to go. It's important to write it down, because later hysteria and blaming and mistakes – including mistakes on my part – would obfuscate the basic philosophy of change I was aiming for. Later on, it would always baffle me, when I was too much in the public eye, how people wouldn't want to handle the ideas being generated. They wouldn't have a clue about the issues at stake or the methods being deployed. They would just want to write about my hair or my girlfriends. This has been happening to me, as you know, on an international scale now, and I don't suppose I've helped the situation one bit. But I didn't invent the media's smallness: I merely got tangled up in it and tried to turn it towards something important. But turning the media's attention towards, say, justice, or the real issues of cause and effect in modern history – well, even the so-called 'good papers' are only interested for a couple of headlines and then they're back to how weird you are. It's the most morally offensive way of living you can imagine, to pretend to be interested in life, and committed to the truth about it, but actually you are not interested in complexity at all. And worse: you are cynical about the possibility of your readers' interest in it. I'll save my Jeremiad until later. But my experience at university told me how complex were the relations between the search for truth and the possibility of justice. It took me, a former hacker, directly into the world that produced WikiLeaks.

There are a few recurring themes in my life, and in the telling of it, too. I already mentioned reading Solzhenitsyn's *Cancer Ward* in Wandsworth. At one point in the story Kostoglotv is discussing the value of university with a